Email Basics

Your Account

1. Which email provider do you use? Is one better than another?
2. Have you ever paid for extra storage or premium email services?
3. Do you know how to set up an email account on your phone?
4. How many email accounts do you have? What is each one for?
5. When did you create your first email account? How old were you?
6. Have you ever forgotten a password and lost an old account?
7. Would you use a company email address for personal things? Why?

Providers

1. Is Gmail, Outlook, or QQ Mail better for work? Why?
2. Do you care about privacy when you choose an email provider?
3. Have you ever changed email providers? What made you move?
4. Is a school or work email ever worth keeping after you leave?
5. Do you trust free email, or would you pay for a safer one?
6. What do you think of email addresses full of random numbers?

Everyday Email

1. How many emails do you get in a day? How many are spam?
2. Do you use email for personal things, or only for work?
3. What do you use email for most — work, shopping, or sign-ups?
4. Do you still send personal emails to friends, or only WeChat?
5. How much time do you need to write a proper email?
6. Do you check email before bed or first thing in the morning?
7. Which emails do you never open? Why?

Spam and Safety

1. How much spam do you get every week? What is it about?
2. Have you ever clicked a link in a suspicious email? What happened?
3. How can you tell a real email from a scam? Give an example.
4. Do you report spam, or just delete it?
5. Have you ever been tricked by a fake delivery or bank email?
6. What should you do if you get an email asking for money?
7. Do you think email will ever be completely safe from scams?

History and Change

1. Do you remember the first email you ever sent? When was it?
2. How did people share news before email? Do you remember?
3. Has email made you more organized, or more stressed?
4. Why is email still so popular at work when WeChat is faster?
5. Do young people today use email less than their parents did?
6. Will email still exist in twenty years? What might replace it?
7. What would make you finally close an old email account?

Email in China

1. Do most people in China use email or WeChat for work? Why?
2. Is email more common in foreign companies than in Chinese ones?
3. Do you write work emails in English, Chinese, or both?
4. What is different about a work email to a foreign client?
5. Is a formal email still important, or is it too old-fashioned?
6. Would you rather get a real letter or an email? Why?